

Darwin Core Maintenance Group call

2025-09-11

Topic: Moving the DwC-DP proposal to public comment

Attending: Steve Baskauf, Pieter Huybrechts, Ben Norton, Tim Robertson, Cecilie Svenningsen, John Wieczorek, Peter Desmet

Regrets: Markus Döring, Jörg Holetschek

DwC model authors: John Wieczorek, Tim Robertson, Paula Zermoglio, Cecilie Svenningsen, Kate Ingenloff, Markus Döring, Peter Desmet, Tobias Guldberg Frøslev

DwC-DP authors: Peter Desmet, Tim Robertson, John Wieczorek

Non-author MG members: Quentin Groom, Jörg Holetschek, Pieter Huybrechts, Kit Lewers, Ben Norton

Notes:

- Issues in DwC repo have been created: <https://github.com/tdwg/dwc/milestone/20>
- Goal of the meeting: consensus on the state of the proposal.
- Criterion 1: Demand (at least two independent entities want the change). We agree there is demand for proposed changes.
- Criterion 2: Efficacy (the proposed change will accomplish the desired outcome)
- Criterion 3: Stability (making the change will not adversely affect the interoperability of existing implementations that depend on the stability of the vocabulary)

Ben comments:

1. "This was done behind closed doors". Vocabulary Maintenance Specification allows this. Anyone can make a proposal, it doesn't need to be a task group.
 - a. Tim's reply: This was all developed openly on GitHub, presented by GBIF with open calls for involvement throughout. It wasn't developed through a TDWG process.
 - b. Peter's reply: this was developed openly by representatives from the Darwin Core Maintenance Group and GBIF, based on numerous use cases. Whether you were involved in this process or not, everyone now has a chance to provide feedback. => **TODO**: incorporate this in the landing page. **DONE**
2. This is an addition to an existing standard, not a new standard. **TODO**: incorporate this in the landing page. **DONE**
3. Communication plan? The announcement needs to be crafted with care and clarity.
4. Should the *Participating in the review* section be at the top, or the bottom of the landing page? Near-consensus was No. Instead a callout pointing to the Participation section was added. **DONE**

5. Foreign key issues, people can generate their own foreign keys. Unclear who will generate them, what they'll be like. Will there be any guidelines about this? -> John; this is not what is under review. This will have to come with tools.

Steve:

- 1) Stability requirement. We need to be careful about the changes we are making to `occurrence`. Descriptions in the proposal: occurrence is a subclass of event, could you have an occurrence table without an event table? Could occurrences and events be placed in the same table? Occurrence: state of organism at an event: Ok, but can they exist without being linked to an event and can they have event properties assigned to them?
 - a) John: an occurrence is an event, strongly. You can not have an occurrence without an event.
 - b) Tim: the data package is an implementation of the conceptional model, that took its own design choices based on testing, research, with lots of people and across lots of use cases.
 - c)

State of implementation at GBIF:

- IPT
- Registry : upcoming
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Post meeting notes:

Kate Ingenloff indicated her support for moving the proposal forward in an email to Steve on 2025-09-15.

Steve completed a comprehensive review of all of the term change proposals on 2025-09-14 and discussed his concerns with John, who made some revisions that can be seen at <https://github.com/gbif/dwc-dp/commit/aaa0feea75ab3d58d3aeb7b9599d2ef47a36b58f#diff-4f7637d9233965988a42ede5a6cda8ed15457bf2acc65733aab218e00ff0304d>. As we discussed at the meeting, addressing all identified issues would remove the last barrier to approving the move to public comment.